DR. PRAMOD JULKA
A LUMINARY IN INDIAN ONCOLOGY

Dr. Pramod Julka's illustrious career and tireless dedication to oncology have made a lasting impact on cancer care in India. His contributions have improved the lives of countless patients and have paved the way for advancements in cancer treatment and research



DR PRAMOD JULKA
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The fight against cancer is on around the world and big strides have been made in its detection and treatment, however, it is still a menace. In India, one man who has taken it head on is Dr Pramod Julka who is a pioneer in the field of oncology. Indeed, few names resonate with as much respect and admiration as Dr. Pramod Julka. Renowned for his exemplary contributions to the field, Dr Julka has established himself as a pivotal figure in cancer care and research in India. His illustrious career, spanning over four decades, has been marked by his dedication to patient care, innovative research, and educational leadership. Received Lifetime Achievement Award at Elets Healthcare Awards Summit 7th June 2024.

Dr. Pramod Julka's journey into the medical world began with a strong academic foundation. He graduated from the prestigious Maulana Azad Medical College in New Delhi, where his passion for medicine took root. Driven by a commitment to combating the devastating effects of cancer, he pursued specialized training in medical oncology abroad.

Dr. Julka's professional career is a testament to his relentless pursuit of excellence in oncology. He has held significant positions in several top-tier medical institutions in India. One of his most notable roles was as the Dean and Professor of Oncology at the All-India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) in New Delhi, one of the most prestigious medical colleges in India.

Dr. Julka is recognized for his deep expertise in the diagnosis and treatment of various cancers, particularly breast cancer, lung cancer, and gastrointestinal malignancies. His approach to patient care is comprehensive, integrating the latest advancements in cancer treatment with a compassionate, patient-centric philosophy. He feels early detection is key and more efforts must be made to facilitate early detection. "If patients come to us early, we have better chance of curing them but many people do not even realise they have cancer and so when they come it is already too late," says Dr Julka.

His passion for fighting the diseases is unwavering. He feels it is a lifestyle disease that can be controlled by making changes in one's lifestyle. "More than half of the cancer cases are due to the use of tobacco and alcohol. Add to it sedentary lifestyle and pollution of air water and eatables. Use of carcinogenic chemicals is another major factor. If we can get rid of these, we can effectively win the battle against cancer" says Dr Julka.

A prolific researcher, Dr. Julka has authored numerous papers in reputed medical journals, significantly advancing the understanding of cancer biology and treatment. Beyond his clinical and academic roles, Dr Julka has been actively involved in shaping healthcare policies related to cancer care in India. He has served on numerous advisory boards and committees, contributing his expertise to initiatives aimed at improving cancer prevention and early detection.

Dr Julka is generous and a kind person who has treated patients without taking into consideration their financial or social backgrounds and given them the best care. He feels one major reason Cancer is such a big issue in the country is that its treatment is costly. "I would personally implore all to take Ayushman Bharat health scheme of the Government of India so that they are covered and get the best of treatment. He also wants that lifestyle that increases the cancer risk must be discouraged and a healthy lifestyle must be promoted. It is important that we create awareness, We should make good use of media print and electronic media to reach out to people and make them aware about the dos and don't so they remain healthy and safe" says Dr Julka.

Dr. Julka's remarkable contributions to oncology have earned him numerous accolades. He has been the recipient of several prestigious awards, including the Padma Shri, one of India's highest civilian honours, in recognition of his services to medical science.

At the core of Dr Julka's professional philosophy is a profound belief in the importance of empathy and patient-centred care. Dr. Julka's legacy extends beyond his clinical achievements. He has inspired a generation of healthcare professionals to pursue excellence with compassion and integrity. Dr. Julka's work undoubtedly continues to inspire others to fight against cancer the disease we all wish did not exist!